

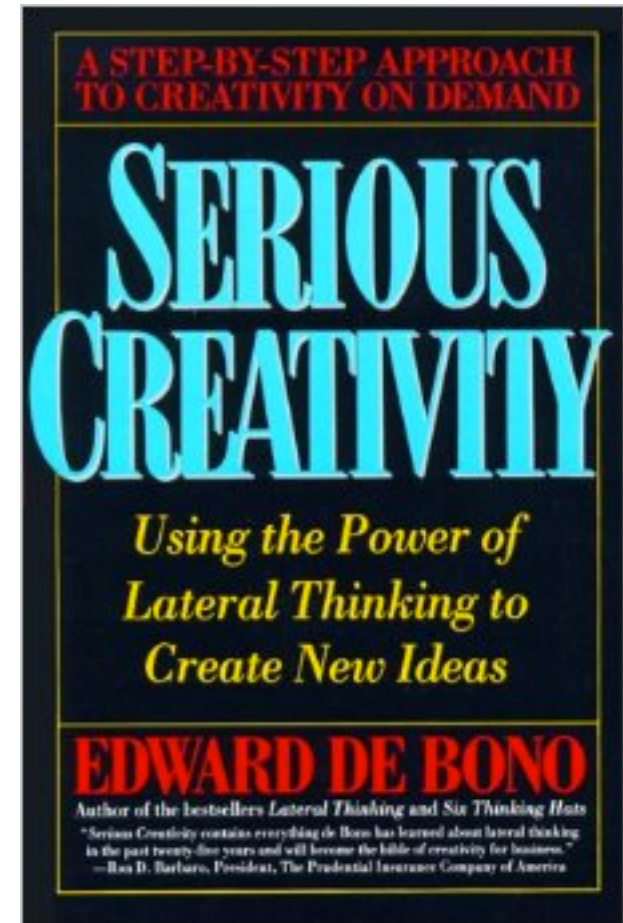
Lateral Thinking Overview

Driving focused creativity

Background on Lateral Thinking

□ Dr. Edward de Bono

- M.D., Ph.D. (philosophy, medicine, and psychology),
Rhodes scholar
- World's leading authority in the field of creative and conceptual thinking
- Consultant to major corporations, governments and organizations, worldwide, for over 25 years
- Originator of Six Thinking Hats, Lateral Thinking, and Direct Attention Thinking Tools
- Author of over 72 books in 43 languages



Lateral and Creative Thinking

- ☐ Creative thinking is not a talent; rather it is a skill that can be learned.
- ☐ Lateral Thinking skills will enable you how to think creatively, find alternative solutions, dramatically increase your number of new and practical ideas, and spark your creativity on demand.
- ☐ Lateral Thinking uses unconventional thinking techniques to identify ideas which usually are missed by our logical ways of thinking.
- ☐ Lateral Thinking is complimentary to tools like 6-Sigma that will generate ideas that can be executed.

Key Benefits of Skilled Lateral Thinking

- ❑ First, it provides a structured approach for generating ideas (“inside & outside the box”).
- ❑ Second, it’s a Fast and Efficient method for producing ideas (minutes not hours or days).
- ❑ Third, it can be applied to solve problems and identify opportunities (for individuals, teams & departments).

Source of “Lateral Thinking” Term

- ❑ In our brains, patterns are formed (pathway A-B). Lateral Thinking is a method for cutting across those patterns laterally to point C to generate new ideas.



- ❑ Every valuable creative idea is obvious in hindsight

Lateral Thinking Example

When an empty plastic bottle is filled with water and buried half-way into the roof of house that the light entering the top of the 2-liter bottle (outside the house) will refract from the water at the bottom of the bottle (inside the house) to create a source of light.



Creating light from darkness

Lateral Thinking Tools

Organizational

Tools and methods that help to better organize the thinking, before during and after the thinking efforts. This results in more effective attention direction and capturing of the output of the thinking efforts. By using these tools, the thinking is broken down into specific and discrete thinking tasks, making the overall effort easier to handle. Better planning of the thinking is also enhanced through use of these tools.

Sensitization

Tools and methods that help the thinking participants to better prepare for the generation of ideas, concepts and alternatives. These techniques work by broadening the participants perception of the issue. They force attention to real or artificial boundaries around an issue and also introducing random, but related elements that may help them move beyond those boundaries.

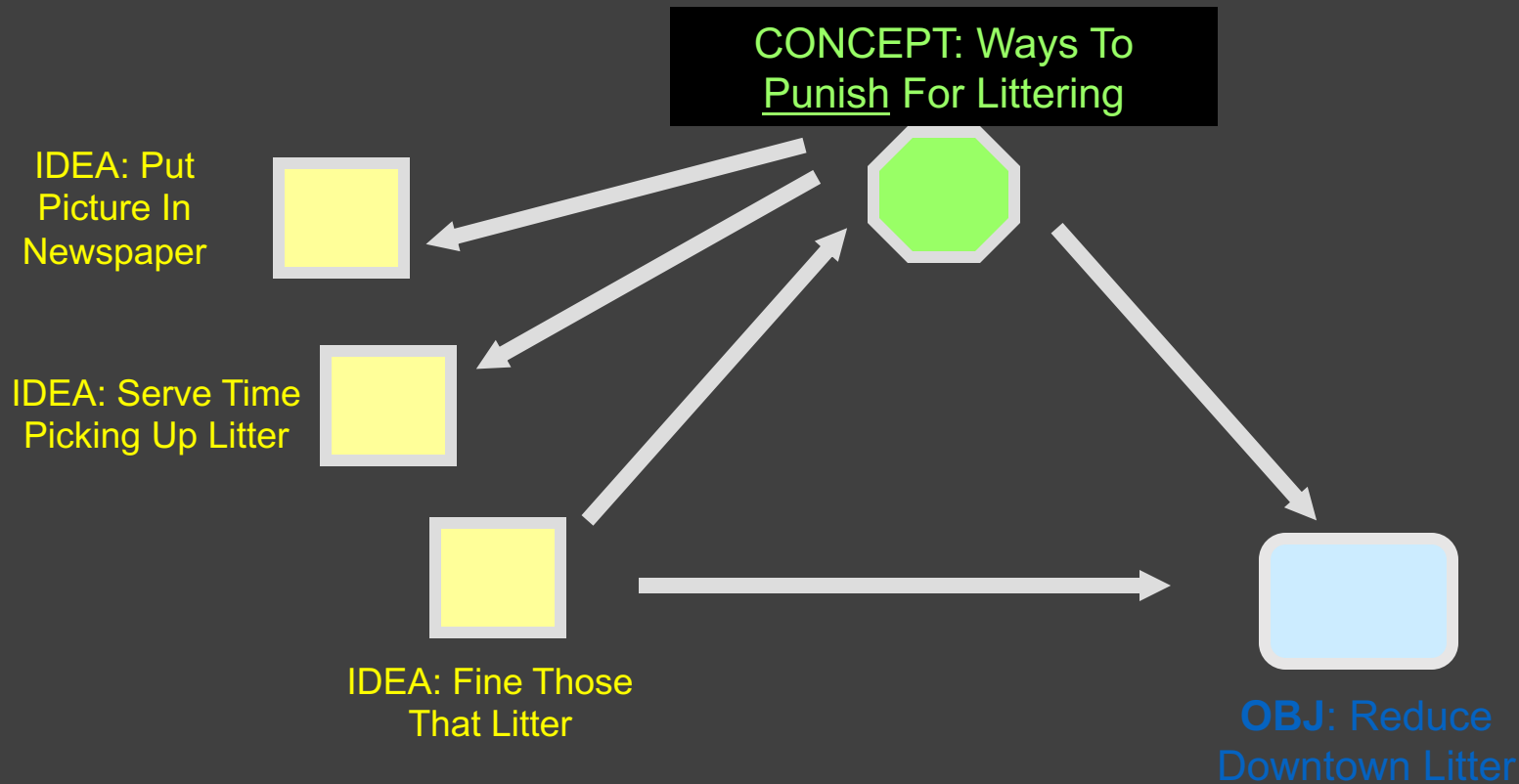
Provocation

Tools and methods that help us to move out of our previous thinking patterns or ruts by allowing the mind to relate previously unrelated ideas. These tools leverage the natural pattern making tendencies and excellence of the mind in order to generate new ideas and approaches.

1. What is the concept behind the idea?

2. Are there any other ways to carry out that concept?

3. Are there any other concepts?



Random Word

"onion"

OBJECTIVE:

Generate ideas on how to make sticky notes more popular

This offer seems a little fishy if you ask me!



Ways to more easily transport sticky notes after writing

Ways to make it easier for sender to clearly indicate something

Ways to have sticky notes indicate something in a unique and fun way

Ways to provide more flexibility to the user

Ways to use shapes to indicate something or enhance the message

Ways to better organize the sticky notes after they are written

Ways to use texture to indicate something or enhance the message

Emboss an image to match the fragrance on the note

Create a small book with clear plastic pages to store notes for travel

Print a blank smiley face on the note so sender can indicate an emotion

Add scents & colors to help get message across - scratch & sniff!!!

Notes that look like were torn out - rough edges

Create a to-do list board so notes can be posted and re-arranged

Make them where they will not stick to pockets, etc. when carried

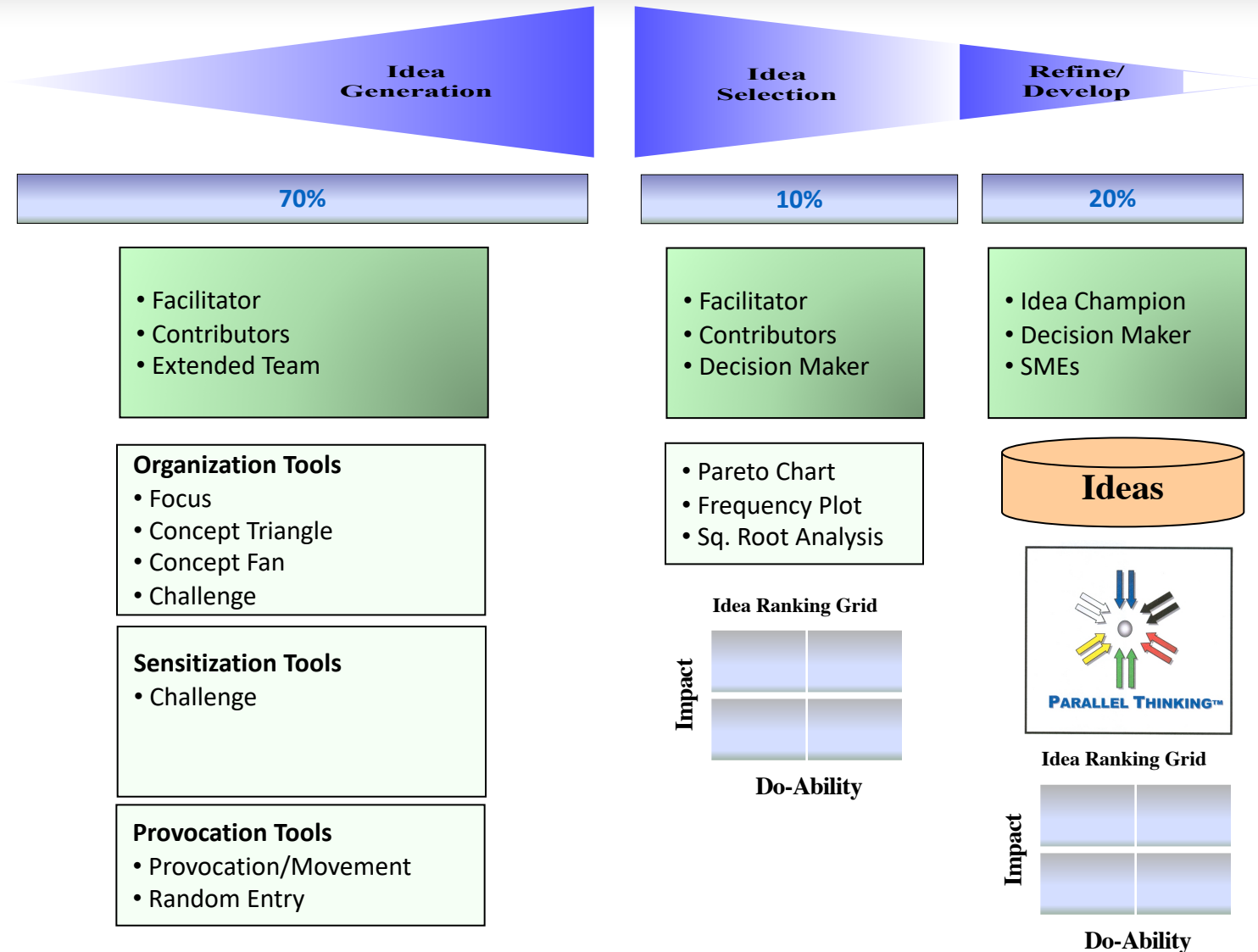
boxes to indicate things

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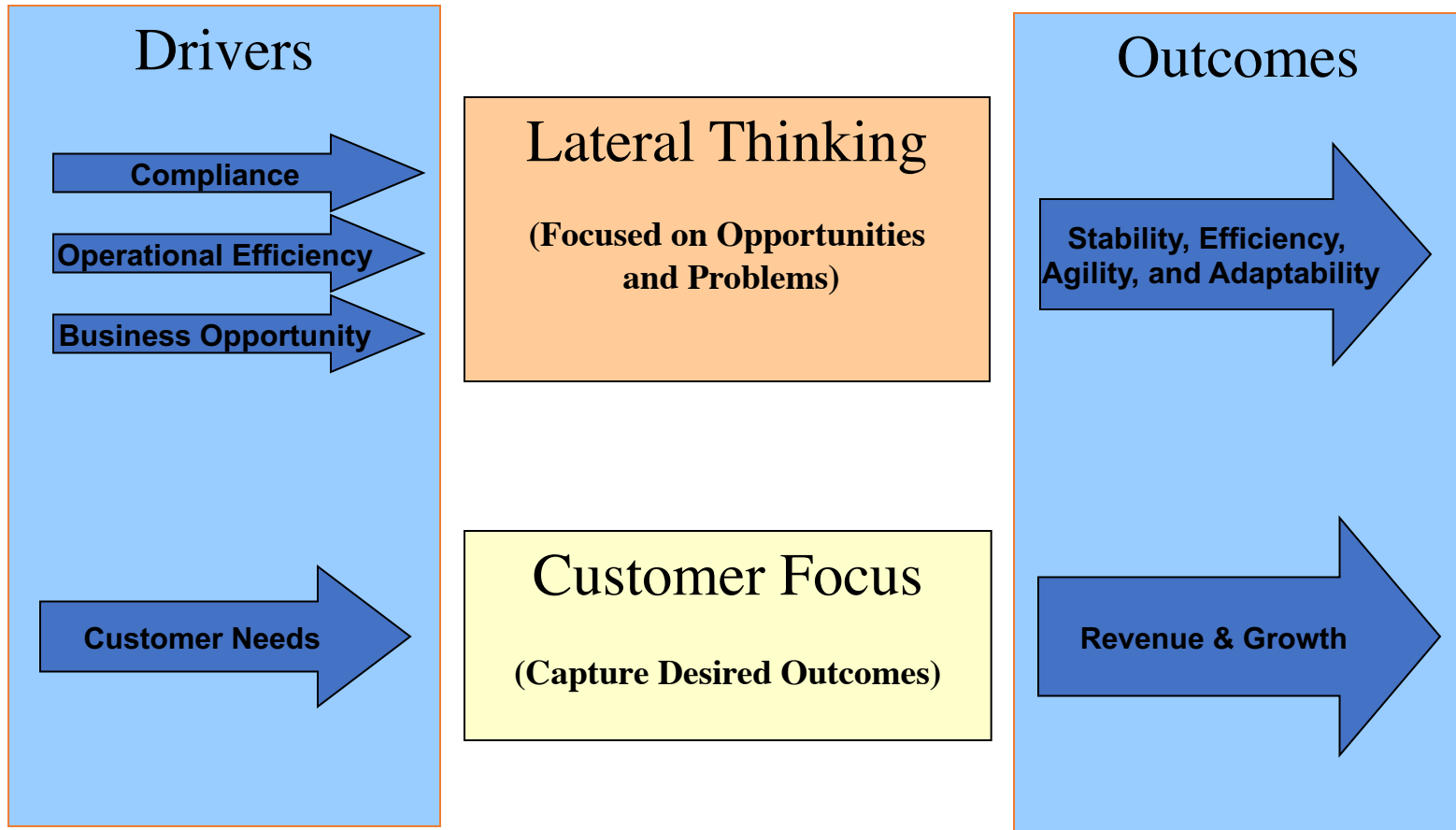
"Are there any

Ask - "What is the concept behind this idea?"

Ideation Process



Driving Innovation & Growth with Lateral Thinking



Positioning of Ideation Tools

- ❑ Business areas and functional areas who are focusing on addressing customer needs through our products and services will be leveraging a structured model for ideation. *Provides a highly structured process for generating ideas that address one or more desired customer outcomes.*
- ❑ Business areas and functional areas who are involved in driving operational efficiency, compliance or are involved in business-driven opportunities (like M&A, Transformational initiatives) will be leveraging the Lateral Thinking model for ideation. *Provides structured techniques for efficiently generating many divergent ideas which can be harvested into one or more ideas to solve problems and/or create opportunity.*

Example Objective:

“Engage everyone at the home office to provide an idea to make the organization more effective so we can improve productivity and redirect savings into product development”

How does it work ?

- ❑ A Focus or Objective Statement is created stating the opportunity or the problem to be addressed.
- ❑ Participants are invited to write down an idea of how to address the issue or opportunity. There are specific criteria to use when submitting an idea.
 - One idea per post a note
 - Idea must be actionable
 - Must be a full sentence with a minimum
- ❑ A facilitator will monitor the Board and pull out the concept behind the idea
- ❑ Participants are invited to look at the concepts and come up with more ideas.

What will be done with the inputs?

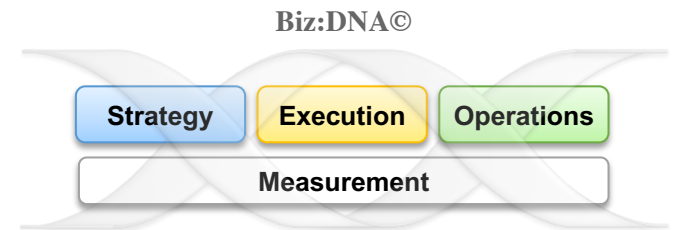
- ☐ Workable ideas will be forwarded to subject matter experts for development!
- ☐ It's easy, it's fun and you could be called upon to be part of the development of an idea!
- ☐ Get involved, be creative and contribute your ideas when you see one in your area!

Why you should consider Lateral Thinking

- Sets the stage for companywide innovation
- Sharpens creative thinking skills
- Quickly find alternative solutions
- Dramatically increase your number of practical ideas
- Evaluate and further develop ideas for execution
- Build an innovative thinking and learning organization

Thank You

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Create and deliver the right value
Build and nurture a winning culture
Proactively manage change & complexity



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